

# Vocabulary

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# Overview

- 1 Loans as a map of the past
- 2 Building words — Derivational Morphology
- 3 Meaning differences between languages
- 4 Some cultural key words

# Outline

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# Loanwords Are a Map of Contact

- Every borrowed word records a **contact**: trade, religion, conquest, fashion
- Old loans blend in; new ones still look **foreign**
- Peel back the layers to read a language's **history**

This week follows Goddard (2005, Chapter 3).

# Four Kinds of Loan

| Kind               | Example              | Comment                                                                           |
|--------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>indigenized</b> | <i>gift, root</i>    | so old nobody notices                                                             |
| <b>prestige</b>    | <i>crown, judge</i>  | high status, like the rulers' language                                            |
| <b>cultural</b>    | <i>coffee, sushi</i> | a new thing arrives                                                               |
| <b>calque</b>      | <i>sky-scraper</i>   | translate the parts:<br>German <i>Wolken-kratzer</i><br>French <i>gratte-ciel</i> |

# English: Layer upon Layer

| When       | From          | Examples                              |
|------------|---------------|---------------------------------------|
| 800s–900s  | Old Norse     | <i>take, get, want, die, low</i>      |
| from 1066  | Norman French | <i>crown, judge, court, army</i>      |
| from 1400s | Latin, Greek  | <i>scientific, describe, bonus</i>    |
| 1500s on   | the world     | <i>canoe, tomato, coffee, tsunami</i> |

- Norse was close to Old English, so its words are now invisible
- Latin was the language of learning; printing spread its words

# The Farmer's Animal, the Lord's Dinner

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| on the farm (English) | on the table (French) |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| <i>cow</i>            | <i>beef</i>           |
| <i>sheep</i>          | <i>mutton</i>         |

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After 1066, French was the language of the rulers and English that of the common people, giving a **dual vocabulary** for common and formal use

# Borrowed Parts Become Productive

*ex-      ex-wife*  
*-able   readable   googleable*

Learned words came from Latin and Greek, often by way of French — and brought affixes that now attach to anything

# Words Travel by Indirect Routes

| Word                     | From     | Via     |
|--------------------------|----------|---------|
| <i>canoe, potato</i>     | Taíno    | Spanish |
| <i>tomato, chocolate</i> | Nahuatl  | Spanish |
| <i>coffee</i>            | Arabic   | Turkish |
| <i>sushi, tsunami</i>    | Japanese | —       |

These loans mark new foods, objects and practices

# Loans Can Change the Sound System

Old English    *leaf* [f]    *leaves* [v]  
 one phoneme /f/, two sounds

after French    *fine*    *vine*  
 two phonemes: /f/  $\neq$  /v/

French loans such as *veal* and *vine* made /v/ a phoneme

# Malay: Religion Brought Words

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|                |             |             |
|----------------|-------------|-------------|
| Sanskrit, Pali | <i>rasa</i> | feel, taste |
|----------------|-------------|-------------|

|              |             |      |
|--------------|-------------|------|
| 2nd c. BC on | <i>nama</i> | name |
|--------------|-------------|------|

|  |             |         |
|--|-------------|---------|
|  | <i>guru</i> | teacher |
|--|-------------|---------|

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|        |              |       |
|--------|--------------|-------|
| Arabic | <i>fikir</i> | think |
|--------|--------------|-------|

|                      |             |           |
|----------------------|-------------|-----------|
| with Islam, 1200s on | <i>ilmu</i> | knowledge |
|----------------------|-------------|-----------|

|  |              |      |
|--|--------------|------|
|  | <i>waktu</i> | time |
|--|--------------|------|

|  |              |           |
|--|--------------|-----------|
|  | <i>haram</i> | forbidden |
|--|--------------|-----------|

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- Malay sits at the **crossroads** of India and China
- Indic loans are fully nativised; Arabic ones keep their fricatives and spellings like *kh*: *khabar* “news”

# Malay: Trade and Empire Brought Words

|            |                                                                       |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tamil      | <i>kedai</i> “shop”, <i>katil</i> “bed”, <i>mangga</i> “mango”        |
| Chinese    | <i>teh</i> “tea”, <i>mi</i> “noodles”                                 |
| Portuguese | <i>gereja</i> “church”, <i>garpu</i> “fork”, <i>almari</i> “cupboard” |
| Dutch      | <i>senapang</i> “gun”, <i>pelakat</i> “placard”                       |
| English    | <i>tiket</i> “ticket”, <i>kamera</i> “camera”                         |

Regional trade first; European colonisers after the fall of Malacca in 1511

# Different Colonisers, Different Loans

|        | Malaysia     | Indonesia     |                         |
|--------|--------------|---------------|-------------------------|
| office | <i>ofis</i>  | <i>kantor</i> | < Dutch <i>kantoor</i>  |
| ticket | <i>tiket</i> | <i>karcis</i> | < Dutch <i>kaartjes</i> |

Malay borrows from English (Britain), Indonesian from Dutch (the Netherlands)

# Thai: Indic Words Are the Formal Register

|      | Native Thai | Indic           |
|------|-------------|-----------------|
| head | <i>hǔa</i>  | <i>sǐisà'</i>   |
| eye  | <i>taa</i>  | <i>phranêet</i> |
| dog  | <i>mǎa</i>  | <i>sunák</i>    |

- Burmese, Thai, Lao and Khmer took Sanskrit and Pali with Theravada Buddhism — and their scripts
- New words are often **calques** on Indic roots: *thoola<sup>2</sup>.that<sup>1</sup>* “television” [far.vision]
- European loans are rarer (though becoming common)

# Chinese in Mainland Southeast Asia

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## Lao, from Chinese

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*toq2*    table

*ngen2*    money

*bòò1*    not

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- Over 1,000 years of contact: Lao, Thai and Vietnamese
- Numbers and **classifiers** especially
- Strongest in Vietnamese, down to basic nouns — and grammar too

# Chinese in Korea and Japan

|    |              |        |
|----|--------------|--------|
| 釈迦 | <i>Shaka</i> | Buddha |
| 鉢  | <i>hachi</i> | bowl   |
| 馬  | <i>uma</i>   | horse  |

- Borrowing begins in the first millennium AD, with Buddhism: traditionally 552 (*Nihon shoki*; 538 in other sources), from Paekche (in Korea)
- Script, religion and social norms came too

# Japanese: Who Brought Which Words

| When      | From       | Examples                                       |
|-----------|------------|------------------------------------------------|
| mid-1500s | Portuguese | <i>tempura</i>                                 |
| Edo       | Dutch      | <i>kokku</i> “cook”, <i>garasu</i> “glass”     |
| Meiji on  | French     | <i>atorie</i> “studio”, <i>ankēto</i> “survey” |
| Meiji on  | English    | <i>terebi</i> “TV”, <i>sararii</i> “salary”    |

Japan was closed to all Europeans but the Dutch until 1854, so French loans are Meiji or later

# Japanese Loans Today: Borrow, Then Rebuild

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|         |                    |                           |
|---------|--------------------|---------------------------|
| loan    | <i>yogapantsu</i>  | yoga pants                |
|         | <i>beddo</i>       | Western-style bed         |
| clipped | <i>rimōto</i>      | remote working            |
| hybrid  | <i>ichigo-ēdo</i>  | strawberry + “-ade”       |
|         | <i>wan-man-kaa</i> | one-man (driver-only) bus |

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Technology, fashion and popular culture borrow most

# Return Loans: 和製漢語 *wasei-kango*

Meiji Japan built new words from **Chinese** morphemes for Western ideas — and China, Korea and Vietnam borrowed them **back**

|       |         | Japanese      | Mandarin      | Vietnamese      |
|-------|---------|---------------|---------------|-----------------|
| 科学/科学 | science | <i>kagaku</i> | <i>kēxué</i>  | <i>khoa học</i> |
| 經濟/经济 | economy | <i>keizai</i> | <i>jīngjì</i> | <i>kinh tế</i>  |
| 社会/社会 | society | <i>shakai</i> | <i>shèhuì</i> | <i>xã hội</i>   |

Some are new coinages (哲学 *tetsugaku* “philosophy”, 電話 *denwa* “telephone”); others give old Chinese words a new sense (經濟 < 經世濟民 “govern the world, relieve the people”). So a Sino-Japanese word need not be a loan *from* Chinese.

# Pseudo-Loans: Made at Home from Foreign Parts

|                   |                | from                   |
|-------------------|----------------|------------------------|
| <i>sararīman</i>  | office worker  | <i>salary man</i>      |
| <i>konsento</i>   | power socket   | <i>concentric plug</i> |
| <i>haendeupon</i> | mobile phone   | <i>hand phone</i>      |
| <i>apateu</i>     | block of flats | <i>apartment</i>       |

Japanese *wasei-eigo* “English made in Japan”, and Konglish

# The Traffic Runs Both Ways

| English          | from                                |                   |
|------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <i>tycoon</i>    | Japanese 大君 <i>taikun</i>           | great lord        |
| <i>ketchup</i>   | Hokkien <i>kê-tsiap</i> (via Malay) | fish brine        |
| <i>emoji</i>     | Japanese 絵文字 <i>emoji</i>           | picture character |
| <i>amok</i>      | Malay <i>amuk</i>                   |                   |
| <i>orangutan</i> | Malay <i>orang hutan</i>            | forest person     |

*emoji* has nothing to do with *emotion*

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# Three Ways to Build a Word

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|                      |                                           |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>affixation</b>    | <i>un-reli-able, sad-ness, re-written</i> |
| <b>compounding</b>   | <i>book-shop, black-board</i>             |
| <b>reduplication</b> | <i>choo-choo</i>                          |

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- **Derivation** makes new words; **inflection** changes a word's form for grammar (tense, number)
- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages have almost no inflection; Japanese, Korean and Austronesian do
- Derivation is more common than inflection in many Asian languages

# Compounding: The Main Way to Make Words

- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages rely on it
- Usually **two** elements: nouns, adjectives or verbs
- Productive, but the meaning is not always predictable

# Mandarin Compounds

|                               |                     | literally      | means      |
|-------------------------------|---------------------|----------------|------------|
| parallel                      | 花木 <i>huā-mù</i>    | flower-tree    | vegetation |
| metaphor                      | 狗熊 <i>gǒu-xióng</i> | dog-bear       | bear       |
| verb/adj.                     | 痛苦 <i>tòng-kǔ</i>   | painful-bitter | suffering  |
| N <sub>1</sub> N <sub>2</sub> | 台灯 <i>tái-dēng</i>  | table-lamp     | desk lamp  |

Productive N<sub>1</sub> N<sub>2</sub> patterns: N<sub>1</sub> is the place, purpose or material of N<sub>2</sub>

# Japanese Compounds: Native, Sino-Japanese, Foreign

|        |                    | literally     | means      |
|--------|--------------------|---------------|------------|
| native | <i>aki-zora</i>    | autumn-sky    | autumn sky |
| S-J    | <i>to-kei</i>      | time-meter    | clock      |
| S-J    | <i>shakai-gaku</i> | society-study | sociology  |
| hybrid | <i>keshi-gomu</i>  | erase-rubber  | eraser     |

Compounding is the most productive way to make words in Japanese;  
Sino-Japanese compounds dominate technical vocabulary

## Rendaku: The Second Part Voices

*aki* + *sora* → *aki-zora* autumn sky

*hito* + *hito* → *hito-bito* people

*te* + *kami* → *te-gami* letter

Native compounds often voice the first consonant of the second element

# Japanese Compound Verbs

|                      | literally   | means                    |
|----------------------|-------------|--------------------------|
| <i>naguri-korosu</i> | beat-kill   | kill by beating (manner) |
| <i>kaki-ageru</i>    | write-raise | write up (aspect)        |

Native and Sino-Japanese compounds order their parts differently: native OV *hon-yomi* “book-reading”, Sino-Japanese VO *doku-sho* “read-book”

# The Action Can Name the Doer or the Tool

|                     | literally    | the action       | also       |
|---------------------|--------------|------------------|------------|
| <i>hito-goroshi</i> | person-kill  | killing a person | a killer   |
| <i>ha-migaki</i>    | tooth-polish | brushing teeth   | toothpaste |

Compound meanings shift from action to agent, instrument or location

# Japanese Loves Abbreviations

*paasonaru konpyutaa* → *paso-kon*

*tōkyō daigaku* → *tō-dai*

大阪大学 *ōsaka daigaku* → 阪大 *han-dai* not 大大!

- Long compounds are clipped to a preferred length
- Blends merge parts of different words
- Everywhere in the media and everyday speech

# Reduplication: Say It Twice

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|            |                    |   |                            |
|------------|--------------------|---|----------------------------|
| Vietnamese | <i>đỏ</i> red      | → | <i>đỏ đỏ</i> reddish       |
|            | <i>trắng</i> white | → | <i>trắng trắng</i> whitish |
| Indonesian | <i>lalat</i> fly   | → | <i>lalat-lalat</i> flies   |

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- Far more common in East and Southeast Asia than in English
- Attenuation, intensity, plurality; often partial, often with a sound change — here the reduplicant loses its tone

# Rhyming and Chiming

|         | Indonesian         |                | English            |
|---------|--------------------|----------------|--------------------|
| rhyming | <i>kaya-raya</i>   | rich           | <i>lovey-dovey</i> |
| chiming | <i>teka-teki</i>   | riddle         | <i>zig-zag</i>     |
|         | <i>bolak-balik</i> | back and forth | <i>flip-flop</i>   |

Often idiomatic and expressive; extensive in Thai and Vietnamese too

# Few Affixes in Sinitic and Mainland Southeast Asia

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|            |                    |                |               |
|------------|--------------------|----------------|---------------|
| Cantonese  | <i>góng-faat</i>   | speak-way      | way of saying |
|            | <i>yihndoih-fa</i> | modern-ize     | modernize     |
| Thai       | <i>kaan-lên</i>    | NMLZ-play      | playing       |
| Vietnamese | <i>phản-kháng</i>  | counter-resist | protest       |

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- Many Vietnamese affixes are Chinese (*phản-* < 反); productive in journalism and academic writing
- Hakka marks gender with suffixes derived from kin terms

# Malay: Rich, Productive Affixation

| root          |       | derived                                       |           |
|---------------|-------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <i>darat</i>  | land  | <i>meN-</i> <i>men-darat</i>                  | go ashore |
| <i>bersih</i> | clean | <i>meN-</i> <i>-kan</i> <i>mem-bersih-kan</i> | to clean  |

Prefixes, suffixes and circumfixes: *meN-* makes dynamic verbs, *-kan* makes transitive ones

# Korean and Japanese: Causative Suffixes

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|          |                |                 |                   |
|----------|----------------|-----------------|-------------------|
| Korean   | <i>bo-</i> see | <i>bo-i-</i>    | show              |
| Japanese | <i>mi-</i> see | <i>mi-sase-</i> | make someone look |

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Korean *-i* has several allomorphs; Japanese *-(s)ase* attaches to almost any verb

# Summary: Who Uses Which Tool?

|                     | compound | reduplicate | affix |
|---------------------|----------|-------------|-------|
| Mandarin, Cantonese | ●        | ◐           | ○     |
| Thai, Vietnamese    | ●        | ●           | ◐     |
| Japanese            | ●        | ◐           | ●     |
| Korean              | ◐        | ◐           | ●     |
| Malay, Indonesian   | ◐        | ●           | ●     |

Isolating languages compound; Austronesian, Japanese and Korean affix

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# Some Words Have No Equivalent

|      |                 |                                 |
|------|-----------------|---------------------------------|
| お見合い | <i>omiaiai</i>  | formal marriage meeting         |
| 酒    | <i>sake</i>     | <b>any</b> alcoholic drink      |
| 日本酒  | <i>nihonshu</i> | “Japanese sake” — the rice wine |

- English borrowed *sake* for the rice wine, but in Japanese it has broadened to all alcohol
- Words for emotions, values and ideals differ too — and so do basic words

# Describing Meaning: Polysemy

How can we describe it when we don't have it in our language?

- Define with **simpler** words, never circular or obscure ones
- **Polysemy**: one word, several related meanings
- Languages **group** meanings differently — so compare the meanings, not just the words

# Languages Carve Up Meanings Differently

| English       | Czech         | Malay          | Japanese          | Mandarin    |                |
|---------------|---------------|----------------|-------------------|-------------|----------------|
| <i>nose</i>   | <i>nos</i>    | <i>hidung</i>  |                   | <i>bízi</i> | of a person    |
| <i>trunk</i>  | <i>chobot</i> | <i>belalai</i> | <i>hana</i>       |             | of an elephant |
| <i>muzzle</i> | <i>čenich</i> | <i>muncung</i> |                   | <i>zuǐ</i>  | of a dog       |
| <i>beak</i>   | <i>zobák</i>  | <i>paruh</i>   | <i>kuchibashi</i> |             | of a bird      |

| English     | Malay          |                  |
|-------------|----------------|------------------|
| <i>live</i> | <i>hidup</i>   | be alive         |
|             | <i>tinggal</i> | reside somewhere |

# The Syntax Can be Different

- Each meaning comes with its own **grammatical frame**
- English *live* “reside” needs a place: *live in Prague*
- Malay *buat*: *buat kuih* “make” vs *buat kerja* “do”

Different arguments  $\Rightarrow$  different meanings

# “Exist (There is)” and “Have”: Often One Word

(1) *Ada dua ekor lembu.*

exist two CLF cow

“There are two cows.” [zsm]

(2) *Orang ini ada dua ekor lembu.*

person this exist two CLF cow

“This person has two cows.” [zsm]

Malay *ada*, Mandarin *yǒu*: one argument means “there is”, two arguments mean “have”

# Even Water Differs

| English      | Japanese      |                          |
|--------------|---------------|--------------------------|
| <i>water</i> | 水 <i>mizu</i> | cold or room temperature |
|              | 湯 <i>yu</i>   | hot                      |

*atsui mizu* “hot *mizu*” sounds odd: Japanese does not have one word for *all* water

# How Do Things Break?

## Malay

*putus* break in two  
*patah* break, not sever  
*pecah* break into pieces

## Japanese

*oru* break off  
*kowasu* destroy  
*kiru* cut off

Cantonese also distinguishes how something breaks: *dá laahn* “smash into pieces”

But is English so different? *destroy*, *cut*, *cut off*, *cut out*, *cut through*, *sever*, ...

# Coming and Going

- English *come* moves towards the speaker *or* the addressee
- Japanese *kuru*, Malay *datang* and Korean *oda* cannot shift the viewpoint that way

English     *I'm coming!*

Japanese   *Ima iki-masu!* “now go”

# How Many Words for Rice?

# How Many Words for Rice?

|         | English     | Malay        | Japanese        | Cantonese      |
|---------|-------------|--------------|-----------------|----------------|
| growing |             | <i>padi</i>  | 稻 <i>ine</i>    | 禾 <i>wòh</i>   |
| raw     | <i>rice</i> | <i>beras</i> | 米 <i>kome</i>   | 米 <i>máih</i>  |
| cooked  |             | <i>nasi</i>  | ご飯 <i>gohan</i> | 飯 <i>faahn</i> |

# How Many Words for Rice?

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|---------|-------------|--------------|-----------------|----------------|
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| cooked  |             | <i>nasi</i>  | ご飯 <i>gohan</i> | 飯 <i>faahn</i> |

Cooked rice often means “a meal”: Japanese *gohan*, Cantonese *sihk faahn* “eat rice” “eat a meal”

# Older and Younger Siblings

|                 | English        | Thai        | Mandarin      |
|-----------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|
| older brother   | <i>brother</i> | <i>phîi</i> | <i>gēge</i>   |
| older sister    | <i>sister</i>  |             | <i>jiějie</i> |
| younger brother | <i>brother</i> | <i>nóu</i>  | <i>dìdi</i>   |
| younger sister  | <i>sister</i>  |             | <i>mèimei</i> |

Relative age sets lifelong seniority in many Asian families

## Birth Order in the Name

- Mandarin: “first brother”, “second brother”, ...
- Malay family nicknames: *long* “oldest”, ..., *teh* “fourth”

Kin terms encode family roles, hierarchy and lineage

# Feelings Live in the Body: Psycho-Collocations

|                           | literally           | means            |
|---------------------------|---------------------|------------------|
| Malay <i>panas hati</i>   | hot liver           | angry, worked up |
| Thai <i>thùuk-cay</i>     | correct heart       | please, satisfy  |
| Lai <i>thin haaN</i>      | liver become liquid | angry            |
| English <i>hot-headed</i> | hot head            | quick to anger   |

A body-part noun + adjective or verb (Matisoff, 1986); Thai, Malay and Lai have dozens — an **areal** feature of mainland Southeast Asia

# Words for Nature and Seasons

- Rich vocabularies for weather, plants, insects and fish reflect traditional ways of life
- Japanese poetry has a whole class of **season words** (季語 *kigo*):

|      |                     |                         |
|------|---------------------|-------------------------|
| 五月雨  | <i>samidare</i>     | early-summer rain       |
| 小春日和 | <i>koharubiyori</i> | mild day in late autumn |

## Summary: Meaning Differs, Even for Basic Words

- Some words have **no equivalent**
- Even basic words **split or merge** meanings differently
- Kinship, rice and emotion words show what a culture **cares about**

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# Cultural Key Words

- Words around which a culture **organizes** a whole domain
- Common, and turn up in proverbs and sayings
- Often have **no equivalent** elsewhere

English      *love, honesty*

Australian      *mate*

Japanese      *omiai*

# Describing Them Without Bias

- English glosses smuggle in English concepts (**ethnocentrism**)
- Instead, explain with **semantic primes**: simple meanings found in every language (Wierzbicka, 1996)

SOMEONE      THINK      GOOD      WANT      BECAUSE

This **Natural Semantic Metalanguage** (NSM) can be checked against native speakers' intuitions

# Malay *malu*

“shame”, “shy”, “embarrassed”

*Aku malu.* “I’m ashamed.”

*Eh! Malu pulak dia!* “Oh, now they’re shy!”

Fear that others will think or say something bad about you ⇒ wanting to avoid them; it keeps people in line

## Explication: *malu*

X feels *malu*

X feels something bad because X thinks like this:

people can know something about me

people can think something bad about me because of this

people can say something bad about me because of this

I don't want this

because X feels like this, X doesn't want to be near other people

it is good if people can feel something like this

## Malay *sabar*

“patience” — but broader: staying calm, enduring without losing control

*Bersabar...*

“Be patient...”

*Sabar, jangan menangis.*

“Calm down, don’t cry.”

*Allah sentiasa bersama dengan orang-orang yang sabar*

“Allah is always with those who are patient”

## Explication: *sabar*

X is *sabar* [at the time]

at this time, X felt something bad

because of this, X could have thought:

I don't want this

I want to do something now

X did not think like this, because X didn't want to think like this

it is good if a person can be like this

*Sabar* takes inner discipline and self-control

Chinese 孝 *xiào*

filial piety: duty, respect and care for parents, alive or dead

百善孝为先 *bǎi shàn xiào wéi xiān*

“Of the hundred good deeds, *xiào* comes first”

父母恩比山高，比海深 *fùmǔ ēn bǐ shān gāo, bǐ hǎi shēn*

“What our parents give us is higher than a mountain,  
deeper than the ocean”

# Explication: 孝 *xiào* (1)

everyone can think about some other people like this:

this person is my father, this person is my mother

I exist because of them

because of this when I think about them I feel something very good

I cannot think about other people like this

it is good if a person thinks about these people at all times

it is good if this person feels something because of this

## Explication: 孝 *xiào* (2)

it is good if a person thinks about these people like this:

I want them to feel something very good at all times  
because of this I have to do many good things for them

I want to do these things

I don't want these people to feel anything bad at any time  
because of this I cannot do some things

I don't want to do these things

it is good if a person thinks like this about some people

it is good if a person does many things because of this

it is bad if a person doesn't think like this about some people

Chinese 忍 *rěn*

perseverance: enduring hardship without complaint, for a greater goal

忍气吞声 *rěn qì tūn shēng*

“endure one’s anger and swallow one’s voice”

Long-term goals over immediate desires; a source of inner strength

# Explication: 忍 *rěn* (1)

everyone can think like this about some things:

I want these things to happen

I know they cannot happen if I don't do some things

I want to do these things because of this

if I have to do these things for a long time I don't want not to do them because of this

if I feel something bad when I do these things I don't want not to do them because of this

## Explication: 忍 *rěn* (2)

it is good if a person always thinks like this

it is good if a person thinks about this when this person feels something bad

it is good if a person thinks about this when someone else does something bad to this person

it is good if a person does many things because this person thinks like this

it is good if a person can be like this

# Japanese 甘え *amae*

dependence: taking someone's love and care for granted

“When I am with Y, nothing bad can happen to me”

Modelled on an infant's dependence on its mother; part of all close relationships in Japan

# Explication: 甘え *amae*

X feels *amae* towards Y

X thinks like this about Y:

when Y thinks about me, Y feels something good

Y wants to do good things for me

Y can do good things for me

when I am with Y nothing bad can happen to me

I don't have to do anything because of this

I want to be with Y

X feels something good because of this

# Japanese 思い遣り *omoiyari*

empathy: knowing what others need without being told  
literally “think-give”

*Omoiyari no aru ko ni natte ne.*

“Please become a person with *omoiyari*.”

*Omoiyari no kokoro o taisetsu ni shimashō.*

“Let’s treasure the heart of *omoiyari*.”

Keeps harmony and avoids conflict

# Explication: 思い遣り *omoiyari*

X has *omoiyari*

X often thinks like this about other people:

I can know what this person feels

I can know what this person wants

I can do something good for this person because of this

I want to do this

this person doesn't have to say anything

because of this, X does something

people think this is good

# Conclusions

- **Loans** map contact history: English, Malay and Japanese are built in layers
- Words are built by **compounding**, **reduplication** and **affixation**, in different mixes
- Languages **carve up meaning** differently, even for water, rice and siblings
- **Cultural key words** can be explained without bias in semantic primes

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